

Staff Guide: Managing Cases

For: HQAdmin, ChapterAdmin, ChapterStaff, Director (Board can view everything below, read-only).

Case statuses

Every case has a Status, and only certain next steps are ever offered:

Status	Meaning
New	Just submitted, nobody assigned yet.
InProgress	Assigned to a volunteer and being worked.
AwaitingShipment	Packed, ready to ship.
Shipped	On its way — needs a tracking number.
Fulfilled	Delivered; the case is closed.
OnHold	Paused for any reason; can resume from here.
Cancelled	No longer happening.

A Prayer-only request skips every package status it doesn't need — it only ever waits on the Prayer Team, never on a Package Assembler.

How to change a case's status, from anywhere you see it:

1. Find the **Status** dropdown (on the case's own page, in My Work Queue's Quick Update drawer, or in the Unassigned Queue's Assign drawer).
2. Open it — only the statuses that are actually valid next steps from where the case is now are listed.
3. Pick one. If you're choosing AwaitingShipment, Shipped, or Fulfilled, also fill in the **Tracking Number** and **Shipped Date** fields that appear.
4. Click **Save Changes** (or **Update Status**, depending on the page).

The Unassigned Queue (/admin/queue)

Lists every New case with nobody assigned yet. New package requests are auto-assigned to a Package Assembler in the same chapter (when auto-assign is on), respecting that volunteer's maximum active cases (a chapter setting, 6 by default) and an acceptance window — 24 hours normally, 4 hours for an Urgent-priority case — before it moves to the next volunteer. Use this queue to assign or reassign by hand anytime.

How to assign a case from here:

1. Find the case in the table and click **Assign**.
2. Review the family summary that opens — contact info, address, reason, how long it's been waiting.
3. Pick a volunteer from the **Assign To** dropdown, or click one of the up-to-5 **suggested volunteers** (ranked by workload) to select it instantly. To assign it to yourself, pick your own name — there's no separate "assign to me" button.
4. Click **Confirm Assignment**.

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Unassigned Queue

English ▾

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Manual Admin

HQAdmin

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Unassigned Queue

Cases awaiting volunteer assignment — oldest first

Needs info (0)

Refresh

All Cases

Package Pipeline

My Work Queue

END

UNASSIGNED

OVERDUE & UNASSIGNED

AVAILABLE VOLUNTEERS

OLDEST WAITING

No unassigned cases — all caught up!

The Package Pipeline board (</admin/kanban>)

A drag-and-drop view of every package case, organized into columns: Unassigned, Assigned, Confirmed ("Volunteer Accepted"), Packing, Notes, Shipping. Drag a card to a new column to move its status and process stage together. Moving a card into **Packing** now also auto-generates a placeholder shipping label behind the scenes (visible on the case's activity timeline) — carrier integration is a future phase.

Package Pipeline

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Package Pipeline

Visual pipeline view of all active cases

Needs info (0)

List View

Unassigned Queue

My Work Queue

NEW

0

Empty

ASSIGNED

0

Empty

VOLUNTEER
ACCEPTED

0

Empty

PACKING

0

Empty

NOTES

0

Empty

SHIPPING

0

Empty

ON HOLD

0

Empty

FULFILLED

0

Empty

CANCELLED

0

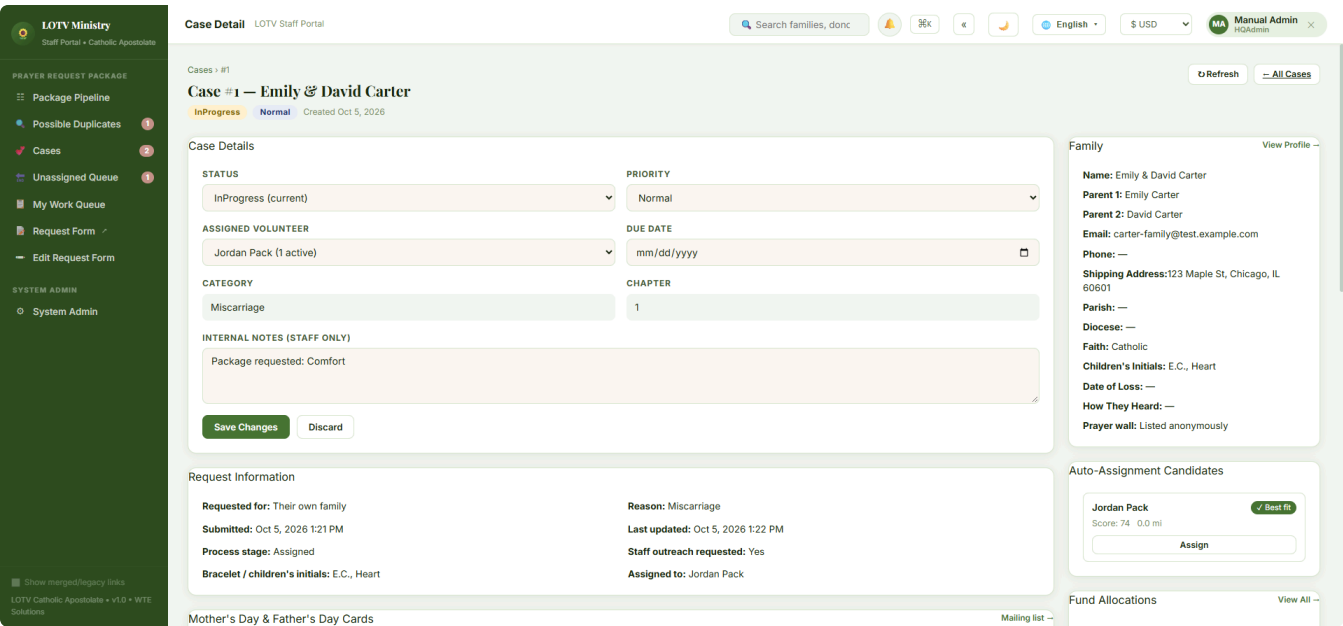
Empty

For the full rundown of every column, what each field on a card means, and how Quick Assign works: [Staff Guide: The Package Pipeline Board](#).

Page 5 of 8

The Case Detail Page — Every Field, and How to Change It

Open any case at `/admin/cases/{id}` — click **Details** from any list, or click anywhere on a card's body (not its buttons) on the Package Pipeline board. This is the one place that shows everything about a case and lets you change almost all of it.



Case Details — the editable panel

Field	What it does
Status	Only the valid next steps are offered (same rules as everywhere else).
Priority	Urgent, High, Normal, or Low.
Assigned Volunteer	Any active volunteer, or — Unassigned —.
Due Date	Optional target date.
Category	Read-only — set automatically from the Reason given at intake.
Chapter	Read-only.
Tracking Number / Shipped Date	Only appear once Status is set to AwaitingShipment, Shipped, or Fulfilled.
Internal Notes	Staff-only free text, never shown to the family.

How to edit any of these fields:

1. Change whatever you need directly in the panel — Status, Priority, Assigned Volunteer, Due Date, Internal Notes.
2. If you set Status to AwaitingShipment, Shipped, or Fulfilled, the Tracking Number and Shipped Date fields appear — fill those in too.
3. Click **Save Changes** to apply everything at once, or **Discard** to throw away your edits and reload what's saved.

Quick Actions — the one-click shortcuts

In the right-hand column, **Quick Actions** offers a button for every valid next status (e.g. " Mark AwaitingShipment", " Mark Fulfilled", " Cancel Case") plus **Unassign** if someone's on it — same transition rules as the Status dropdown, just one click instead of picking-and-saving. + **New Case for This Family** starts a second request for the same family.

Auto-Assignment Candidates

A ranked list of volunteers for this specific case, with a ✓ **Best fit** tag on the top suggestion, a score, and distance in miles. Click **Assign** on any of them to hand the case off immediately — no drawer, no extra step.

Packing List

Add items from chapter inventory (with quantity), check them off as they're packed, or remove one. If you try to move toward Shipped with items still unchecked, a warning shows so nothing ships half-packed.

How to add an item: pick it from the — **Select item** — dropdown (only items with stock on hand are listed), set the quantity, and click **Add**. Check the box next to an item once it's packed; click **Remove** to take it back off the list.

Prayer Team

Add or remove Prayer Ambassadors for this family — completely separate from whoever's assembling the package; any number of people can be praying for one family at once.

How to add someone: pick them from the — **Add a Prayer Ambassador** — dropdown (only people with that role, not already on the team, are listed) and click **Add**. **How to remove someone:** click **Remove** next to their name.

Notes Thread

The family's own story from the intake form always leads the thread (read live from the family record, not copied — it stays current if the story is ever corrected). Add your own notes below it, optionally checking **Internal only** to keep a note hidden from the recipient.

How to add a note:

1. Type it into the box at the bottom of the Notes Thread.
2. Check **Internal only** if it shouldn't be visible to the recipient (staff only — this checkbox doesn't show for volunteers).
3. Click **Add Note**.

Activity Log

A full timestamped history of everything that's happened to the case — who assigned it, who changed its status, when it was created — each entry attributed by name.

Family panel and Other Requests

The right-hand **Family** panel shows full contact info, address, parish/diocese, faith tradition, date of loss, how they heard about LOTV, and their prayer-wall privacy choice, with a **View Profile** → link for deeper family-level edits. **All Requests from This Family** lists every other case tied to the same family, so you can catch a possible repeat request before shipping a second package.

Possible duplicate families (`/admin/families/duplicate-review`)

If a new request looks like it might be the same family as an existing case, it's held out of the Unassigned Queue and auto-assignment, and shows here instead until staff confirm it's a new family or merge it.

A case's own page (`/admin/cases/{id}`)

Assign or reassign a volunteer, change priority, add internal notes, and use the quick-action buttons to move through valid next statuses — the same rules as the Pipeline board, just one case at a time.